

Betsy & Steve — Complete Bridge Conventions

Betsy & Steve Agreements

Convention Card

Open questions:

- Convention card - Coded 9's and 10's

General Approach

System: Standard American | **5-card majors** | **1st-4th seat**

Convention Reference

Fully Documented

Convention	What it covers
<u>Major Raises</u>	Bergen, Jacoby 2NT, Splinter, Dreary
<u>Dreary</u>	Two-way Drury variant — passed-hand raises or natural minor one-suiters
<u>Inverted Minors</u>	Single raise of opener's minor
<u>Defense vs. 1NT Interference</u>	After double or suit overcall over partner's 1NT
<u>NTResponses.md</u>	Stayman, Jacoby Transfers, Texas Transfers
<u>SupportDoubles.md</u>	Support Doubles / Redoubles
<u>RKC1430.md</u>	Roman keycard 1430 slam bidding
<u>NewMinorForcing.md</u>	New Minor Forcing
<u>WONT.md</u>	System for overcalling opponents 1NT
<u>MichaelsCuebid.md</u>	Michaels Cuebid
<u>Unusual2NT.md</u>	Unusual 2NT

Not Yet Adopted - Potentially discuss

- Help suit / game try suit
 - Fourth Suit Forcing
-

Notrump Openings

Bid	Range	Responses	Notes
1NT	15-17 HCP	<u>Stayman</u> ; <u>Jacoby Transfers</u> ; <u>Texas Transfers</u>	Range announced ; transfers announced
2NT	20-21 HCP	<u>Stayman</u> ; <u>Jacoby Transfers</u> ; <u>Texas Transfers</u>	Range announced ; transfers announced

After opponent interference over 1NT: see detailed notes

Major Openings (5+ cards, 1st-4th seat)

Response	Points	Support	Notes
2M	6-10	3 cards; or exactly 6 with 4 cards	
<u>Bergen 3♣</u>	10-12	4	Alertable
<u>Bergen 3♦</u>	7-9	4	Alertable
3M	0-5	4	Preemptive; alertable
<u>Jacoby 2NT</u>	13+	4	Game forcing or better; alertable
<u>Splinter</u>	13+	4	Singleton/void; alertable
<u>Dreary 2♣</u>	10+	3-card support, or natural clubs (11+)	Passed hand; off over interference; alertable
<u>Dreary 2♦</u>	10+	4-card support, or natural diamonds (11+)	Passed hand; off over interference; alertable

Minor Openings (3+ cards each)

Response	Points	Notes
<u>Inverted single raise</u>	10+	Forcing; no 4-card major; alertable
Double raise	0-9	Preemptive/weak, alertable

Two-Level Openings

Bid	Points	Shape	Responses	Notes
2♣	22+	Any	2♦ = waiting	
2♦ / 2♥ / 2♠	5-11	6-card suit	2NT = forcing inquiry	

Overcalls

- **Simple (1-level):** 8-17 HCP
- **Simple (2-level):** 11-17 HCP
- New suit by advancer is non-forcing constructive

Jump overcall: Intermediate — sound when vulnerable, light when non-vulnerable

NT overcalls: - Direct 1NT: 15-18 HCP, systems on (Stayman, transfers) — range **announced** - Balancing 1NT: 12-14 HCP — range **announced** - Jump to 2NT over a **suit** opening: 2 lowest unbid suits (Unusual 2NT) - Over opponent's 1NT: WONT, not Unusual 2NT

Michaels Cuebid: Alertable - Over a minor: both majors - Over a major: other major + a minor

Doubles

Type	Through	Notes
Negative	3♠	
Support	2♠	
Takeout vs. preempts	4♠	
Takeout + bid: 18+ hcp		

Slam Conventions

RKC Blackwood: 1430 — 5♣ = 1 or 4 key cards; 5♦ = 0 or 3 — **alertable**

Defense vs. Opponent's 1NT

WONT

Carding

- **Primary signal:** Attitude, then suit preference
- **vs. trump suit:** Lead A from AK

Other Conventions

- **New Minor Forcing:** After 1m - 1M - 1NT or 2NT, the other minor = forcing, asks about opener's shape — **alertable**

Alertable and Announced Bids Summary

Announced = partner describes the bid aloud. **Alerted** = partner says "Alert" and waits for opponent to ask.

Announced (partner describes aloud):

Bid	What partner says
1NT opening	"15 to 17"
2NT opening	"20 to 21"
Jacoby Transfer (2 ♦/2 ♥ over NT)	"hearts/spades"
Texas Transfer (4 ♦/4 ♥ over NT)	"hearts/spades"

Alerted (partner says "Alert"):

Bid	Situation
<u>Bergen 3♣</u>	4-card support, 10-12 pts
<u>Bergen 3♦</u>	4-card support, 7-9 pts
<u>3M raise</u>	4-card support, 0-5 pts (preemptive)
<u>Jacoby 2NT</u>	Game-forcing raise, 4-card support
<u>Splinter</u>	Game-forcing raise, singleton/void
<u>Dreary 2♣</u>	Passed hand: 3-card support or natural clubs
<u>Dreary 2♦</u>	Passed hand: 4-card support or natural diamonds
<u>Inverted minor raise</u>	Forcing, 10+ pts, no 4-card major
<u>New Minor Forcing</u>	After 1m - 1M - 1NT or 2NT
<u>WONT 2♣/2♦/2♥/2♠/DBL</u>	Over opponent's 1NT opening

Notrump Responses

Covers responses to 1NT (15-17) and 2NT (20-21) openings.

1NT Responses

Majors	Responder Point Range		
	0-7 <i>Signoff</i>	8-9 <i>Invitational</i>	10+ <i>Game Forcing</i>
2-3 majors	Pass	2NT	3NT
4 or 4-4	Pass	Stayman and bid • No fit → 2NT • Fit → 3 of major	Stayman and bid to game • No fit → 3NT • Fit → 4 of major
5 in one major	Transfer and pass	Transfer and bid 2NT	Transfer and bid 3NT
6 in one major	Transfer and pass	Transfer and 3 of major	Transfer to game • No slam interest → Texas Transfer (4 level transfer) • Potential slam interest → Jacoby Transfer (2 level transfer)
5-4	Transfer and pass	Stayman and bid • No fit → 2 of 5-card major • Fit → 3 of major	Stayman and bid to game • No fit → 3 of 5-card major • Fit → 4 of major
6-4	Transfer and pass	Stayman and bid • No fit → 2 of 6-card major • Fit → 3 of major	Stayman and bid • No fit → 4 of 6-card major • Fit → 4 of major
5-5	Transfer and pass (best major)	Transfer to ♠ and bid • After transfer → 3♥	Transfer to ♠ and bid to game • After transfer → 4♥

Responses to 2NT (20-21)

No invitational zone — 4+ HCP opposite 20-21 is game-forcing. Stayman is 3♣; Jacoby Transfers are 3♦/3♥; 4NT is quantitative (not Blackwood).

With slam interest, follow the same game-forcing path to establish a fit, then pursue slam via RKC or — without a major fit — a quantitative 4NT. We have no firm agreements on exact point thresholds for slam tries opposite 2NT, so judge based on controls and fit.

Majors	Responder Point Range	
	0-3 <i>Pass</i>	4+ <i>Game Forcing</i>
2-3 majors	Pass	3NT (or 4NT quantitative with slam values)
4 or 4-4	Pass	3♣ Stayman and bid to game • No fit → 3NT • Fit → 4 of major (or slam try if strong)
5 in one major	Pass	Transfer → bid 3NT (let opener choose 3NT or 4 of major)
6 in one major	Pass	Texas Transfer → 4 of major (no slam interest) Jacoby Transfer → cue bid or 4NT (slam interest)
5-4	Pass	3♣ Stayman and bid to game • No fit → 3 of 5-card major • Fit → 4 of major (or slam try if strong)
6-4	Pass	Texas Transfer → 4 of major (or Jacoby + side suit with slam interest)
5-5	Pass	Transfer to ♠ → bid 4♥

Texas Transfers

Used to transfer directly to game in a major, usually with a long suit and enough for game but no slam interest.

Auction: 1NT - 4♦ → opener bids 4♥; 1NT - 4♥ → opener bids 4♠

Responder bids	Transfers to
4 ♦	4 ♥ (game in hearts)
4 ♥	4 ♠ (game in spades)

When to use Texas vs. Jacoby: - Texas: game values, no slam interest, 6+ card major
- Jacoby: game or slam possible, or need to describe hand further

Major Raises

General Approach

- A simple raise to 2M covers two hands: 3-card support with 6–10 points, or exactly 6 points with 4-card support
- Use Bergen (3♣ or 3♦) to show 4-card support in the 7–12 point range
- Use a preemptive 3M to show 4-card support with 0–5 points (alertable)
- Use Splinter to show game-forcing 4 card support with a singleton or void. Usually the singleton or void is not an honor.
- Use Jacoby 2NT to show game-forcing **or better** 4 card support
- Use **Dreary** (our two-way Drury variant) with a passed hand — 3+ card support, **or** a natural 5+ card minor with no support (see [Dreary](#) for the full convention)
- After a splinter bid, if opener has wasted honors in the short suit, opener usually will sign off in game

When to choose splinter or Jacoby 2NT

- A splinter usually is limited in point range to less-than-slam. It puts your partner in control of deciding how high.
- Because your honors are usually not in the splinter suit, partner could potentially explore slam if there's a good fit in other suits and they don't have many HCP in the splinter suit.
- Jacoby 2NT can be slam-worthy. It puts you in control of deciding how high.

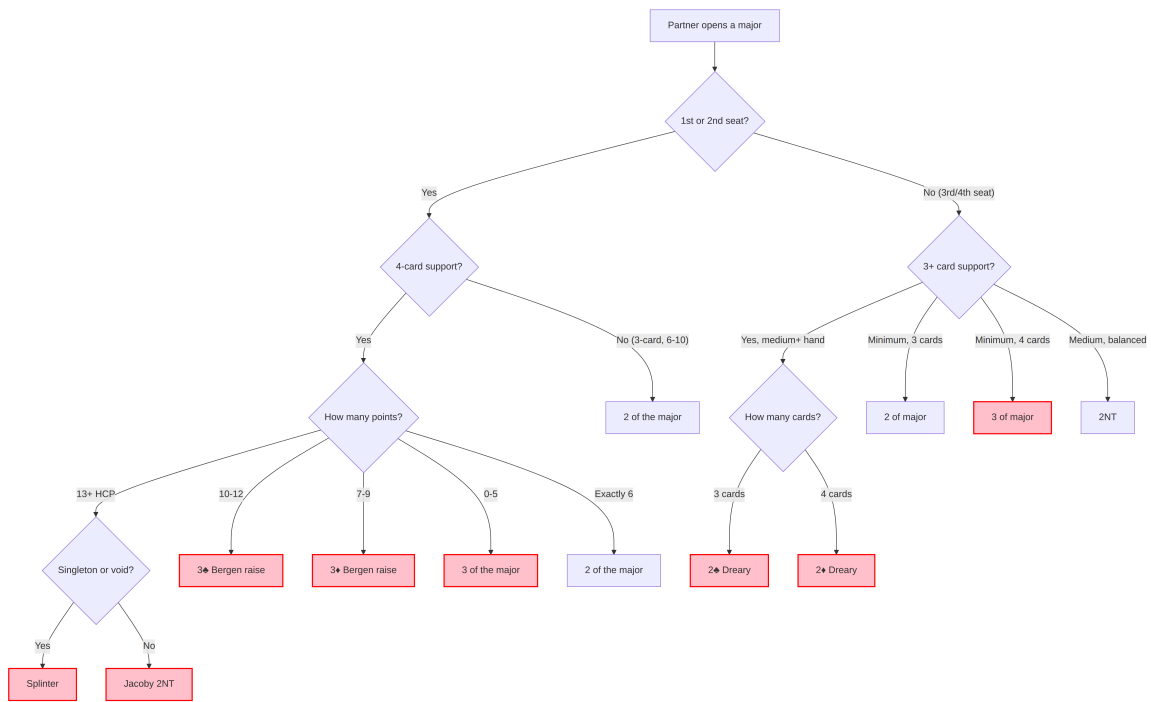


Diagram 1

Alertable

Dreary

A modified two-way Drury that adds natural 5+ card minor one-suiters for responder. Used by a **passed hand** after partner opens 1 ♠ or 1 ♥ in 3rd or 4th seat.

Standard two-way Drury shows a limit raise (2 ♣ = 3-card support, 2 ♦ = 4-card support) and guards against a light 3rd/4th-seat opening. Dreary keeps all of that and gives the previously homeless minor one-suiter a defined, constructive path.

When It Applies

- Responder is a **passed hand** and partner opens 1 ♠ or 1 ♥ in 3rd or 4th seat.
- **Off over any interference**, including a double. If either opponent acts over the opening bid, all bids are natural.

Notation: *M* = opener's major; *m* = the minor responder actually bid (clubs after 2 ♣, diamonds after 2 ♦). Examples use 1 ♠; **1 ♥ is identical with hearts as trumps** — the interior 2 ♠ step is simply bypassed, and a passed-hand spade one-suiter just bids a natural 1 ♠ instead of using the convention.

Key Principle — Stay in Your Lane

You always know your lane from your own hand:

- **Support lane** — any spade support (3- or 4-card).
- **Minor lane** — no support, but a real 5+ card minor.
- With **both**, support always wins.

Commit to your lane on your first bid and **never switch**. 2 ♣/2 ♦ are ambiguous to opener, but never to you. (Wandering from the support lane into a minor-lane bid is the one way to bury a 4-4 major fit — don't.)

Responder's First Bid

Bid	Shows
2♣ (alert)	3-card spade support, 10+ — or natural 5+ clubs, 11+ (no support)
2♦ (alert)	4-card spade support, 10+ — or natural 5+ diamonds, 11+ (no support)

Opener's Rebid — Strength Rungs

Bid	Range	Meaning
2M	up to ~14	Light / minimum — signoff rung
2NT (alert)	15-17	Medium — invitational rung
3M	18+	Maximum — top rung

Opener shows strength *before* knowing responder's lane. The suit rungs (2M, 3M) are natural; **2NT is artificial** and does not show a balanced notrump hand.

Whenever opener shows **15+** (the 2NT or 3M rung) opposite responder's 10+, both lanes are committed to game. Invitational decisions live **only at the 2M minimum rung**.

After the Minimum Rung (2M)

Opener has shown ≤ 14 and is trying to sign off.

Support lane:

Bid	Meaning
Pass	Minimum end of range; accept the signoff
3M	Top of range, no useful shortness; mild invitation
New suit	Game try
4M	To play — maximum support, wants game opposite the announced minimum

Minor lane:

Bid	Meaning
Pass	Doubleton in M — content to play the 5-2 fit
2NT (alert)	0-1 in M; pass-or-correct (opener passes 2NT or corrects to 3m)

There is deliberately **no direct 3m** here. The pass-or-correct is self-correcting: opener passes 2NT only when notrump beats the minor (short in m, with stoppers), which is exactly when you'd have disliked 3m anyway.

After 2m - 2M - 2NT (opener answering the pass-or-correct)

Opener	Meaning
Pass	Notrump is the better spot (pass if NT is preferable to the minor)
3m	Correct to the minor

After opener passes or corrects, responder places the contract normally, assuming no major fit.

After the Medium Rung (2NT)

Opener has shown 15-17. **Both lanes are committed to game.**

Support lane — forcing to game:

Bid	Meaning
4M	To play

Minor lane — game values (26+ combined). The game is almost always **3NT**:

Bid	Meaning
3NT	To play
3m	Forcing; "pick a game." Opener chooses 3NT (default) or, with a fit and a notrump hole, 5m

- The target is **3NT**, which needs ~25 — you have it. 5m needs ~29 plus a real fit and is only the fallback; you rarely reach it.
- **No pass** — the combined range is game-going.

After the Maximum Rung (3M)

Opener has shown 18+ — **both lanes are game-forcing**. Responder clarifies the lane and places the game:

Bid	Meaning
4M	Support lane — to play
3NT	Minor lane — to play

4NT is Roman Keycard (1430) only when a fit has been established (the support lane's 4M). With no fit — after the minor lane's 3NT — **4NT is quantitative**.

Alerts

Rule of thumb: **notrump bids in this system are conventional and alert; the natural suit rungs do not**. Alert rules vary by jurisdiction and platform — when in doubt, alert and be ready to explain the whole convention.

Bid	Alert?
2♣ / 2♦ (responder's first bid)	Yes
2M (minimum)	No — natural
2NT (medium)	Yes
3M (maximum)	No — natural
Responder's 2NT / 3NT pass-or-correct bids	Yes

Inverted Minors

General approach: - Opener bids a minor. - Responder has no 4-card major, 10+ points, and support for opener's minor: - 1♣ opener: 5+ clubs required - 1♦ opener: 4+ diamonds required - Responder bids 2 of the minor. - Goal is to explore No Trump by figuring out which suits are stopped, or short-circuit to the minor if No Trump isn't viable

Responder bids after 1 of a minor by opener

Bid	Range	Notes
3m	0-5	5+ card support (alert)
1NT	6-9	
2m	10+	5+ clubs / 4+ diamonds (alert)

Opener rebids after 1m - 2m

Bid	Range	Notes
2♣/2♦/2♥/ 2♠	12-14	Bid stoppers up the line
3m	12-14	no stoppers. non-forcing
2NT	=14	All higher-ranking suits stopped. Non-forcing. Picture bid
2♣/2♦/2♥/ 2♠	15+	No singleton or void. Bid stoppers up the line. Opener is responsible for making sure the auction does not stop below 3NT
3NT	18-19	Balanced hand with 18-19

Asking for a stopper

Once 3 of the 4 suits have been spoken for, a bid of the 4th suit is 'asking'.

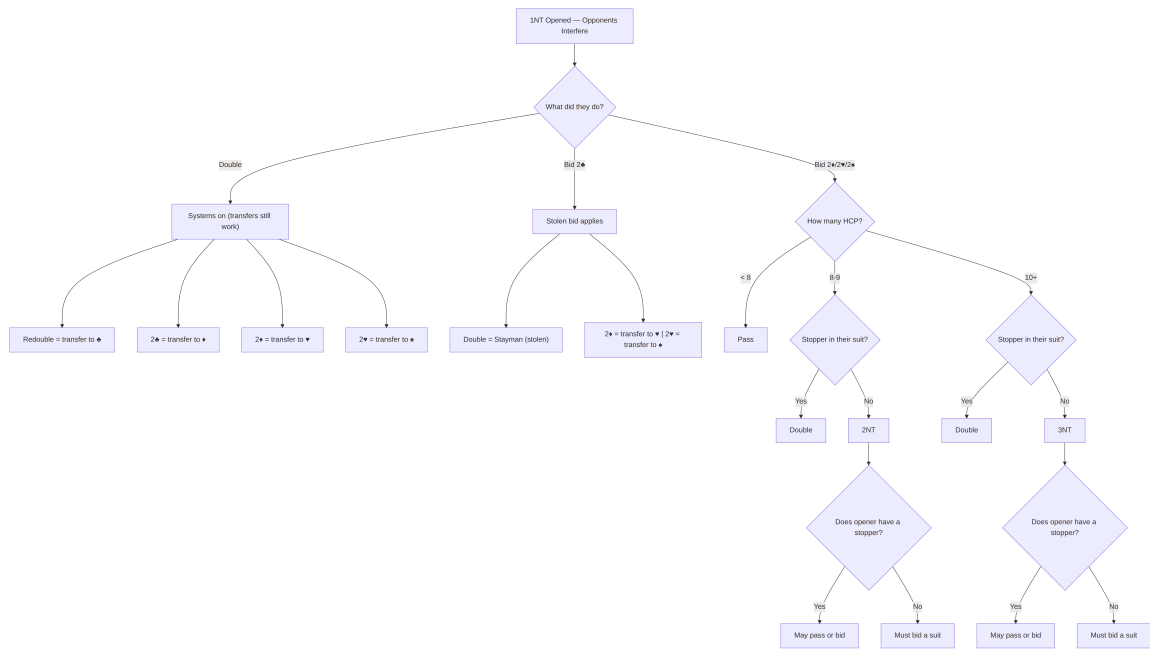


Diagram 1

Support Doubles and Redoubles

Used by opener to show 3-card support for responder's major when opponents interfere.

Support Double

When it applies: Opener has opened, responder bid a major, and an opponent overcalls (through 2♠).

Auction example: 1♣ - (P) - 1♥ - (1♠) - **Dbl** = opener has exactly 3 hearts

Opener's action	Meaning
Double	Exactly 3-card support for responder's major
Raise to 2M	4-card support

Why it matters: Responder now knows whether to expect 3- or 4-card support when bidding game or slam, which affects how they evaluate their hand.

After the support double, responder knows opener has exactly 3-card support.
Responder's options:

Responder action	Meaning
2 of own major	Minimum hand; does NOT promise 5 cards — may be only 4
3 of own major	Invitational (typically 8-10 pts with 5+ cards)
2NT	Invitational (8-10 pts, no major interest)
3NT / 4M	Game-forcing, places contract
New suit	Natural and forcing (game interest)
Pass	Convert to penalty double; Happy to defend against their overcall

Key principle: Rebidding the major at the 2-level after a support double is a minimum, non-forcing action. It does **not** promise 5 cards in the major — opener has shown 3, and together you know you have a 7-card fit (possibly 8 if responder holds 5). Responder passes or raises based on combined values, not assumed trump count.

With 3-card support from opener: - 7-card fit (4+3) is playable but not ideal — prefer NT at higher point counts if the hand is balanced. - 8-card fit (5+3) plays normally — bid the major.

Support Redouble

When it applies: Same situation as the support double, but the opponent **doubles** instead of overcalling.

Auction example: 1♣ - (P) - 1♥ - (Dbl) - **Rdbl** = opener has 3-card support for hearts

Opener's action	Meaning
Redouble	3-card support for responder's major
Raise to 2M	4-card support

Applies through: 2♠ (same as support double)

Roman Keycard Blackwood (RKC 1430)

Used to count key cards (the four aces plus the king of trumps) before bidding slam.

The Ask

4NT = asking for key cards (must have a clearly established trump suit)

The “1430” naming refers to the responses:

Response	Key cards held
5♣	1 or 4 key cards
5♦	0 or 3 key cards
5♥	2 key cards, no trump queen
5♠	2 key cards, with trump queen
5NT	2 key cards and a void

The Queen Ask

After a 5♣ or 5♦ response: - **5 of trumps** = sign off (not interested in the queen) -
Cheapest bid that is not trumps = queen ask

Response to queen ask	Meaning
5 of trumps (or 6 if forced)	No trump queen
6 of trumps	Has trump queen

Examples: - Trumps are **spades**, response 5♣: 5♦ (queen ask) - 5♠ (no) / 6♠ (yes).
Sign off = 5♠ directly. - Trumps are **spades**, response 5♦: 5♥ (queen ask) - 5♠ (no) / 6♠ (yes). Sign off = 5♠ directly. - Trumps are **hearts**, response 5♣: 5♦ (queen ask) - 5♥ (no) / 6♥ (yes). Sign off = 5♥ directly. - Trumps are **hearts**, response 5♦: 5♠ (queen ask) - but now “no” = 6♥, so you’re already at slam.

The queen ask can force you to the 6-level — this happens with hearts (after a 5♦ response) and always with minors. Only ask for the queen when you can afford to be at 6 if the answer is no, or when trumps are spades (always safe). This is part of why the guidelines below warn against using RKC when you could be forced past 5 of trumps.

When to Use / When NOT to Use RKC

Use 4NT when: - Trump suit is clearly agreed or unambiguously implied - You have no two fast losers in any side suit - You're in slam-investigation range and need keycard information

Don't use 4NT when: - **You have a void** — partner's key card in your void suit is worthless, and you can't evaluate accurately. Use cue bids instead, or Exclusion Blackwood if you play it. - **No trump suit is agreed** — 4NT is ambiguous and might be natural/quantitative after a NT opening or when no suit has been bid and supported. - **You're not in slam range** — don't fish for information you won't act on. - **You'd be forced past 5 of trumps** — if the response could land you at the 6-level with two keycards missing, don't ask. - **After 1NT or 2NT** without an agreed fit — 4NT is quantitative, not Blackwood. - **Partner has shown a very weak hand** — Blackwood can't fix a bad trump suit or missing controls in side suits.

New Minor Forcing

Used by responder after a 1NT or 2NT rebid by opener to ask about opener's shape, particularly major-suit length.

When It Applies

Auction: 1m - 1M - 1NT - 2♣ or 2♦ (the *other* minor = new minor) **Auction:** 1m - 1M - 2NT - 3♣ or 3♦ (the *other* minor = new minor)

- Responder bids the **unbid minor** as an artificial, forcing bid
- Does **not** show clubs/diamonds — it's asking opener to describe further

Requirements for responder: - Invitational or better values (typically 10+ HCP) - Wants more information before placing the contract

Opener's Responses

Priorities (in order from most important to least): 1. Bid the other major if you have 4+ cards in it. 2. Bid partner's major if you have 3 card support in it. 3. Show your range or shape otherwise

Opener rebid	Meaning
2M (responder's major)	3-card support
2♥ (if spades was the major)	4 hearts
2NT	Minimum, no 3-card major support
3M	3-card support, maximum
3NT	Maximum, balanced

What Is NOT New Minor Forcing

- If partner has not rebid 1NT or 2NT, it's not new minor forcing if you bid a new minor. Partner will expect that you probably have that minor
- If no majors have been bid before the 1NT or 2NT, it's not new minor forcing

WONT

Defense convention used over an opponent's 1NT opening. Modified version of DONT

The Convention

- 2♣ - clubs and another suit, with a 5-4 or better shape
 - Advancer passes if clubs is not the worst possible suit
 - If it is the worst possible suit, advancer bids 2♦ and overcaller passes or corrects
- 2♦ - Diamonds and a major (5-4 or better)
 - Advancer passes if Diamonds is not the worst possible suit
 - If it is the worst possible suit, advancer bids 2♥ and overcaller passes or corrects
- 2♥ - 6+ hearts
- 2♠ - 6+ spades
- Double - EITHER a 6-card minor or 5-4 majors - relay bid
 - Advancer must bid 2♣
 - With a 6 card minor, overcaller will bid it
 - With both majors, overcaller will bid 2H, and advancer will pass or correct

Michaels Cuebid

A cuebid of opener's suit to show a two-suited hand.

The Convention

After an opponent opens 1 of a suit, a **direct cuebid** (2 of opener's suit) shows a specific two-suiter:

Opponent opens	Your cuebid	Shows
1 ♣	2 ♣	Both majors (5+ hearts and 5+ spades)
1 ♦	2 ♦	Both majors (5+ hearts and 5+ spades)
1 ♥	2 ♥	Spades + an unspecified minor
1 ♠	2 ♠	Hearts + an unspecified minor

Point Range / Strength

Generally a strong enough hand that we might win the auction. If you expect opponents will win the auction because your hand is so weak, don't bid Michael's because it gives the opponents too much information.

Responses by Partner (Advancer)

Advancer bid	Meaning
2M (known major)	Preference, not forcing
3M (known major)	Invitational
4M (known major)	To play
2NT	Asks for the minor (if applicable)

Unusual 2NT

A jump to 2NT over an opponent's opening bid to show the **two lowest unbid suits**.

The Convention

2NT (jump) over an opponent's opening = 5+ cards in each of the two lowest unbid suits

Opponent opens	Your 2NT shows
1 ♥	Clubs and diamonds (the two lowest unbid suits)
1 ♠	Clubs and diamonds
1 ♣	Diamonds and hearts
1 ♦	Clubs and hearts

Point Range / Strength

Unusual 2NT is primarily a **shape bid**, not an HCP bid — suit quality and distribution matter more than point count.

Vulnerability	Typical strength
Not vulnerable	~6-11 HCP; prioritize suit quality over points
Vulnerable	~8-11+ HCP; suits should be headed by at least a Q or better

With 12+ HCP and 5-5 shape, the hand may be strong enough to act differently (e.g., overcall then bid again). Very strong 5-5 hands should usually not preempt with 2NT — they deserve more.

Responses by Partner (Advancer)

Advancer **must** choose a suit — the 2NT bidder has shown 5-5, so partner picks the better fit.

Advancer bid	Meaning
3 of lower suit	Preference, to play; weak hand (0-8)
3 of higher suit	Preference, to play; weak hand (0-8)
4 of lower suit	Preemptive; good fit, weak hand
4 of higher suit	Preemptive; good fit, weak hand
Cue bid of opponent's suit	Game-forcing; asks 2NT bidder to clarify better/longer suit

Cue bid = “I want to be in game, tell me more.” The 2NT bidder rebids the longer or better suit, which advancer converts to game.

Unusual 2NT vs. Natural 2NT

A 2NT overcall is **unusual** (showing two-suited hand) when made as a direct jump over an opening bid at the 1-level.

A 2NT bid is **not Unusual** when: - Made over an opponent's **1NT** opening — we play WONT instead - Made after an opponent's weak two-bid (e.g., 2♠ - **2NT** = natural, strong balanced 15-18) - Made as a response or rebid in an uncontested auction

When in doubt: if a natural 2NT makes sense given the auction, treat it as natural. If it's a jump overcall over a **suit** opening at the 1-level, it's unusual.